

This project investigates the declining performance in a 30-store retail chain over 18 months using sales, store, customer and loyalty data. It includes a structured AI prompt, a stakeholder brief generated from its output and a short reflection on the prompt design using RCTTCE.

RCTTCE Prompt:

ROLE:

You are a Senior Retail Business Analyst with expertise in retail performance, customer analytics, sales trends and loyalty programme evaluation.

CONTEXT:

A retail company operates 30 stores and has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. I need to investigate the causes of the decline and identify opportunities for improvement. A dataset includes store performance, product sales, customer transactions and loyalty programme activity.

TASK:

Investigate the trends in store performance, product sales, customer purchasing behaviour and loyalty programme engagement and generate 3 key business questions that should be analysed to identify potential root causes of the decline and highlight opportunities for improvement.

FORMAT:

The questions should be in a numbered list. For each question, include a business question, why it matters and the data required

CONSTRAINTS:

Do not assume results that are not supported by the data. Questions must be specific and measurable, use only the given data sources, keep insights practical and avoid vague wording.

EXAMPLE:

Business Question:

Has the average revenue generated per store declined consistently over the last 18 months, or is the decline concentrated in specific stores or regions?

Why It Matters:

This helps determine whether the problem is company-wide or driven by a small number of underperforming locations.

Data Required:

Store performance data, revenue, transaction date, and region.

SITUATION SUMMARY

The retail chain operates 30 stores and has recorded declining performance over the last 18 months. The CEO needs clarity on what is driving the decline and where improvement is possible. The analysis focuses on store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity.

Three Key Business Questions

1. Has revenue decline been uniform across all stores or concentrated in specific locations or regions?
2. Has customer purchase behaviour changed in terms of frequency, basket size, or spending level?
3. How does loyalty programme activity influence repeat purchases and customer retention?

Decisions these questions will inform

- Whether to close or restructure underperforming stores
- Whether to adjust pricing, promotions, or product mix
- Whether to strengthen or redesign the loyalty programme
- Where to focus retention and customer recovery efforts

Description of Available Data

- Store performance data: revenue, store_id, region, time-based sales trends
- Product sales data: product_id, product_name, category, units_sold, revenue
- Customer transaction data: customer_id, transaction_date, revenue, purchase patterns
- Loyalty programme data: loyalty_points, engagement activity, repeat purchase behaviour

REFLECTION

I set the role to a senior retail analyst so the output stays within business thinking. Then the context and task link the analysis to the issue of declining store performance and to guide the AI toward generating focused, measurable business questions from the dataset. I included constraints and an example to control the quality of responses, reduce vague outputs and make the expected level of detail and accuracy clear.